

Alejandro Velazquez

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SUMMARY

Product Design leader with 17+ years of experience building and scaling FinTech, Open Banking, Payments, SaaS and platform products across Europe. Proven track record leading product strategy, discovery, design systems and design operations within highly regulated environments.

Experienced partnering with executive leadership, Product and Engineering teams to deliver customer-centred solutions that improve adoption, reduce complexity and drive measurable business outcomes. Specialised in API-first platforms, developer experiences, payment infrastructure and enterprise SaaS products.

EXPERIENCE

Lead UX Designer & Manager — Founding Designer

Jan 2020 – Present

Yapily — London — one of Europe's leading Open Banking infrastructure providers

- Led product design across Payments, Data Connectivity, Platform Services, Developer Experience and Customer Onboarding.
- Designed and launched Yapily's Customer Console and self-service onboarding experience, targeting a 35% reduction in onboarding time and a 38% reduction in support tickets.
- Led the strategy, design and launch of Hosted Pages, reducing customer integration effort from 6 months to 2 weeks, and targeting a 47% reduction in support tickets and a 25% increase in conversion. Now used by 200 companies, including Google, Adyen, Intuit, Ant Financial and Revolut.
- Led design of the Hosted Pages analytics console, giving banks and product teams self-serve visibility into performance and eliminating manual CSM export and PDF reporting overhead.
- Established product discovery, research and validation frameworks that improved decision-making and reduced delivery risk across product teams.
- Built three design systems from scratch for different consumers — internal tools, the white-label customer-facing foundation, and the marketing site — documented in Storybook and Figma, with the governance process behind them.
- Partnered with executive leadership to shape product strategy, prioritisation and long-term platform vision.
- Led customer research programmes with fintechs, partner banks and enterprise customers across Europe.
- Leading migration of the design systems into AI tooling as part of a company-wide AI transformation, so colleagues outside design can produce on-brand material directly.
- Manage a team of two product designers, owning hiring, onboarding and performance reviews; have managed seven designers across six years as the team changed shape.
- Handed ownership of each established design system to a designer on the team, and built the approval process governing how components are added and changed.
- Supported the compliance team in preparing FCA presentations, working design decisions through compliance rather than submitting them for approval afterwards.
- Worked with designers and product managers at Google over two years as they built open banking products on Yapily.
- Influenced strategic product decisions supporting millions of Open Banking transactions annually.

Lead Product Designer

2018 – 2019

HeadBox — London — enterprise event technology and SaaS platform

- Led Product Design across marketplace and SaaS platform experiences serving enterprise customers, event planners and venue operators.
- Designed and launched the company's first SaaS product for venue partners, generating £150,288 ARR (117 customers) within 3 months — 4x the prior model's performance — creating a new revenue stream beyond marketplace transactions.
- Established the design system, governance framework and research practice used across the organisation.
- Defined booking, venue sourcing and operational workflows supporting enterprise event management experiences.
- Partnered with Product and Engineering leadership to deliver strategic roadmap initiatives.

Senior Product Designer (Contract)

Nov 2016 – Dec 2018

Docomo Digital — London — global payments and commerce infrastructure provider

- Led design initiatives for NOMO, a marketplace payments platform supporting merchant onboarding, compliance, wallet management and automated vendor payouts through APIs.
- Designed payment, payout and reconciliation experiences for international marketplaces and sharing-economy platforms.
- Collaborated with Product, Service Design and Engineering teams across Europe and Asia.
- Simplified complex financial workflows involving settlements, merchant management and international payments.

Lead Product Designer

Oct 2013 – 2016

Payfriendz — London — digital wallet and peer-to-peer payments platform

- Directed mobile and web experience design across multiple product releases.
- Worked closely with founders and product leadership to define product strategy, customer experience and platform evolution.
- Designed user journeys supporting digital wallets, peer-to-peer payments and emerging embedded finance capabilities.
- Introduced user research and usability testing practices that informed product decisions and feature prioritisation.
- Contributed to the evolution of the platform from a consumer payments product towards a scalable fintech infrastructure offering.
- Result: £5M+ transferred by 150,000+ users; ranked #1–3 in the Apple App Store finance category.

Product Designer (Contract)

Jan 2013 – Oct 2013

Payango — Berlin — worked remotely from Philadelphia, USA

- Designed user experiences for prepaid card, digital banking and payment products, improving customer journeys and product adoption.

Design Analyst

Sep 2008 – Aug 2011

Globant — Argentina

- Designed enterprise products and digital experiences for organisations including Google, JP Morgan, PwC, Coca-Cola, Telefónica and Travelocity, working within multidisciplinary product and engineering teams.

Early Career

2005 – 2012

Andimol, Bilitee, Sysnet Mexico, Datasigma & Independent — Argentina

- Interaction design and UX/UI consultancy for Latin American firms (Andimol); founded Bilitee, a social network for developers and designers (self-employed); motion design work for Nokia HQ information screens (Sysnet, Mexico — worked remotely from Argentina); freelance and web design roles (Datasigma, independent), building foundational experience across interaction, motion and web design.

EDUCATION

Escuela Da Vinci — Multimedia & Web Design

Universidad de Buenos Aires — Human Resources (Relaciones Laborales)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design Leadership · Product Strategy · Product Discovery · Open Banking · Payments · Financial Infrastructure · Platform Products · Developer Experience · Enterprise SaaS · Design Systems · Design Operations · User Research · Accessibility · Stakeholder Management · Team Leadership

SPECIALTIES

Payments · Open Banking · Financial Infrastructure · Platform Products · Developer Experience

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- 17+ years designing and scaling digital products.
- 10+ years in Payments, FinTech and Financial Services.
- Reduced customer integration effort from 6 months to 2 weeks through the design of Hosted Pages.
- Set and designed against targets of a 47% reduction in support tickets and a 25% increase in conversion for Hosted Pages.
- Built and scaled design systems, governance frameworks and design operations across multiple organisations.
- Extensive experience designing API-first, platform and developer-focused products.
- Influenced products supporting millions of Open Banking transactions annually.